OAKLAND TECH EYES TITLE
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Ban on MTBE delayed

FILE PHOTO

THE PHILLIPS PETROLEUM oil refinery in Rodeo, pictured here in 1999, is the only California refinery to have eliminated the toxic additive MTBE, according to California Energy Commission statistics.

Hold on additive plan stumps state refineries

By Alan Zibel
STAFF WRITER

Before Gov. Gray Davis's decision Friday to delay banning MTBE by one year, the state's oil refineries were in different stages of preparation for the changeover in the state's formula for clean-burning gasoline.

In particular, ChevronTexaco Corp. said it was eager to implement the ban, which Davis ordered three years ago.

After the announcement, reaction ranged from frustration to approval.

Of California's 13 oil refineries, only one — the Phillips Petroleum refinery in Rodeo — now is producing gasoline

Please see **Delay,** NEWS-11

Inside

▶ **OPEC SAYS** it will not alter production cutback. **BUSINESS-1**

ROBERT CASILLAS — Associated Press

CHEVRONTEXACO said it was eager to implement the MTBE ban, which Gov. Gray Davis ordered three years ago. Reaction to the delay ranged from frustration to approval.

Davis says step will avert gas crisis

By Steve Geissinger
SACRAMENTO BUREAU

SACRAMENTO — In a sweeping, election-year reversal, Gov. Gray Davis on Friday delayed banning a gasoline additive that taints water supplies in an effort to avert a new energy crisis in which motorists could suffer fuel shortages and soaring prices.

Davis administration officials said the governor postponed his ban of the suspected cancer-causing MTBE by 12 months, from Jan. 1, 2003, to Jan. 1, 2004, amid a quagmire of political and real-world factors that leave no clear way to immediately replace the additive.

MTBE makes up more than 10 percent of the gasoline supply in car-crazy California.

While blaming the Republican Bush administration and out-of-state energy companies for much of the dilemma, the Democratic governor — seeking re-election in November — said Congress is debating legislation that would provide the solution. But the fate of that bill is far from certain.

Reaction in Washington split mostly along party lines, with Democratic U.S. Sens. Dianne Feinstein and Barbara Boxer, both from the Bay Area, backing Davis' decision, but with Republicans offering

Please see **Ban,** NEWS-11

Caltrans stymies casino dream

City, port say they are filing lawsuits

By Robert Gammon
STAFF WRITER

Oakland Mayor Jerry Brown and City Manager Robert Bobb's plans for a Las Vegas-style casino on the waterfront have suffered a major setback at the hands of the state Department of Transportation.

Caltrans, with the help of the Federal Highway Administration, has taken about 52 acres of land along Oakland's shoreline to use as a staging area for the new 82.6 billion eastern span of the Bay Bridge, a project that could take up to 10 years to complete.

Ownership of the property, which sits on the former Oakland Army Base just south of the Bay Bridge Toll Plaza, was to be transferred later this year from the U.S. Army to the city of Oakland and the Port of Oakland.

Twenty-six acres of that land, known as the Burma Road Terminal, had been earmarked for Brown and Bobb's often-criticized plan for a four-star hotel and possible American-Indian casino.

But the move by Caltrans to take control of the property, which has angered top Army officials, not only raises serious doubts about the hotel and casino's future, but also jeopardizes the city and port's entire proposal for the Army base. That proposal has taken more than seven years to compile.

"The property is ours," Caltrans spokesman Greg Bayol said Friday. "The Federal Highway Administration deeded it to us."

The city and port, however, are fighting back. Officials said they were filing lawsuits late Friday afternoon in both federal and state courts in Sacramento and San Francisco against Caltrans and the Federal Highway Administration.

Despite the litigation, top city and port officials were quick to say Friday they have been in negotiations with Caltrans throughout this week to resolve the dispute.

They also said the city and port are not interested in stopping the long-overdue seismic upgrade of the bridge, part of which collapsed in the 1989 Loma Prieta earthquake.

"It's in everybody's interest to

Please see **Casino,** NEWS-11

Oral Lee Brown helping kids again

Oakland altruist renews pledge to pay for college

By Kristin Bender
STAFF WRITER

OAKLAND — Oral Lee Brown is at it again, making remarkable promises to students in Oakland's toughest neighborhoods: "Stay in school and I'll pay for college."

Two years ago, Brown made good on a 1987 pledge to foot the college tuition bill for a first-grade class at Brookfield Elementary School as long as the children completed high school. Nineteen of the 23 took her up on the offer.

Now, with the help of local Realtors, she's "adopted" 60 more Oakland youngsters — three groups of 20 students each currently enrolled in first, fifth and ninth grades.

"Somebody has to train these kids. Somebody has to teach them, and if not me, who?" Brown said last month on NBC's "Today Show." "We must do it. It has to be done."

Staying in school is often challenging for Oakland students. Roughly 25 percent of the city's high school students drop out before graduating, according to state data released last year.

"When they are given this kind of incentive, there is a higher success rate," said Gus Saar, a marketing executive with Old Republic Title, who contributes part of his salary to the Oral Lee Brown

Please see **Brown,** NEWS-11

Yates spared

▶ **ANDREA YATES** was sentenced to life in prison Friday after prosecutors opted not to pursue the death penalty. **NEWS-4**

Mideast violence

▶ **NINE PALESTINIANS** were killed Friday despite U.S. efforts to broker a cease-fire. **NEWS-11**

SINN FEIN leader Gerry Adams joins hands with dancers during his Oakland visit Friday to dedicate a street that bears his name.

JOHN J. KIM — Staff

City welcomes Gerry Adams to his street

By Laura Counts
STAFF WRITER

OAKLAND — Sinn Fein leader Gerry Adams got an Oakland-style welcome Friday as he was greeted by Irish step dancers with bouncing curls who shared the stage with African dancers in colorful sarongs and Aztec dancers in feathered headdresses.

Adams, a leader in the Irish peace process, clasped hands with members of the multicultural group and danced briefly with them during a dedication ceremony for the small street named after him.

"It's a personal honor and very gratifying that they would name a street after someone like me," said Adams, 53, who was imprisoned as a young man for his involvement in the struggle for a free Ireland and went on to became president of the Sinn Fein political party in 1983. He has since become internationally recognized for his work in the peace process.

"It's a mark of the way people connect across a huge ocean and a whole continent," Adams added.

Adams met with President George Bush and Secretary of

Please see **Street,** NEWS-11

Inside

ANG NEWSPAPERS

NEWS-2

Mineta on racial profiling
U.S. transportation secretary opposes using the practice at the nation's airports

Justice for IMMIGRANT WORKERS

BUSINESS

Brighter jobs picture
For the first time in months, Bay Area unemployment drops
Inside Cityside

WEATHER

Forecast
Rain
High: mid-50s
Low: low 40s

Yesterday
High: Richmond, 60
Low: Berkeley, 37

INDEX

Bay Area NEWS-2
Landers LIVING-2
Legals CLASS-17
Lottery NEWS-2
Movies LIVING-4
Obits CITYSIDE-4
Opinion CITYSIDE-5
Scores SPORTS-9
Weather LIVING-10

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